Chapter 13

The Haregirl and the Moon

SUMMARY. When the animals were still people, their old man, Moon, one day went down into a hole in the ground. The people thought he had died, and wondered who would take care of them. They drank water from their waterhole and moved on to another waterhole when the water died. Later the raisin berries were ripening in their abandoned village, so the women were going back there to collect it and were bringing it home to the new village. One day one of their women, the haregirl, went with them to the raisin berry patch. The other women deceived her about which ones to gather, saying she should eat the red ones, and only gather the white ones. She did so, and when she opened her carrying skin they scolded her for collecting unripe berries. They told her to dump those out and go back for ripe ones– that they would wait for her. She did so, and while she was gone, they all pissed in the waterhole and told the piss to answer when she called out, so that the haregirl would think the other women were still there. When she came back to the abandoned village with her second batch of gathered berries and other things, she was eating a !*ama* bulb. She didn't see the women, so she called out and the piss answered.

Meanwhile, the old man Moon had found a tortoise and was sitting at the entrance to his hole in the ground at the abandoned village. He tried to entice the haregirl to give her the !*ama* bulb, but she was afraid because she thought he was a dead person. She stuck the bulb on the end of her digging stick so she wouldn't have to come close to him, but he grabbed the stick and pulled her into the hole. Moon said, "Why are you afraid of me? I'm still alive, and I want to give you a message so you can tell the other people. Tell them that when people die they will imitate me, the Moon, and will be alive again." The haregirl ran back to her people and told them, "Old Moon says that when people die they will not return, that their flesh will smell

bad." She then returned to Moon and told him what she had said to the people. He was angry and split her mouth with an axe; that's why the hare has a split mouth. She then took her gemsbok skin cloak and charred it in the fire. When she threw it over the Moon's face, the dirt of the female gemsbok skin made the marks on his face that we see today.

SPEAKER. !*Unn*|*obe Morethlwa*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *Tsamkxao Fanni* |*Ui, Jafet Gcao Nqeni,* |*Ai*!*ae Fridrick* |*Kunta*

ehee
yes
ju gesin sa o
some people who were
ǁ'a !hamhi sa tsi ǁa'ike n|a g‡hahan o ju|'hoansi te !xuni
those little animals of today long ago were people and lived
te ha n!ui n!a'an ha hin tsi he ku n!un, kohm, ku se ǁ'a o si o Ju|'hoan te si !xuni
and the old moon here was standing, and saw that they they were Ju|'hoansi and were living
te ǁ'atca tsi ke ha ka ku
and then at that time he
g!a'ama ka n!un n!un ka m ko ha te !ai ka ha g|a'i ǁ'atca hin tsi ha o
entered (went down) and stayed stayed so we said he died and then came out, that is what he did
si ku !xuni oo te ha !ai
they went on living and he died
te si ko "huu, n!au n!a'an o e ma ka !ai
and they said "huu, our old man has died
hajoe xae ka ku !om-!om e te n!aua he !ai?"
who will keep us healthy if this old man has died?"
si koe nǁae te !xuni te !xuni te !xuni te kua tsi !au
they thus said and lived and lived and lived and soon left
te u
and went
te g!u n!ang ma si koh ku tchi khoe n!un te si koh !xoana koa ke te ha !ai te si
and the little water hole they were drinking from thus stood and they lived over here and he died and they
!au !hara ǁ'a g!u n!ang ma te g|ae !xoana koa ke
moved across that little waterhole and went and lived over here

te n|ang n!oma ǁ'a ǁaun|hoa o si ga
and the raisin berries had ripened in their abandoned village
n|ang n!oma te si
the raisin berries had ripened and they
si ku ǁama ǁ'akoa te ku !'hu ka
they came from there and were gathering it
te ku tsi gǁaan ka khau ka khau ka khau ka ku tani ka, te ku
and went and spent the day and collected and collected and collected and were bringing it home, and
si !'hu ka khau ka, ka tani ka
they went gathering and picked it and brought it home
te ǁa'i n|ui he oo si!a !'hu ka te
and one day they all gathered it and
ǁ'a dshaua hin o !'hai
that woman who was a hare
ǁ'a !'hai hin tsi o !'hai ma tze
that hare was a small hare
ǁ'a ha o, ǁ'a dshaua o dshau |'hoan di te ge |xoa si!a
and she was, that woman was a regular woman who stayed with them
si!a !'hu ka te
they gathered it and
u g!a'ama ka |ho te si!a !oa ha, si!a gesin tcoahn ha
went and entered the raisin berry patch and they all told her, some of them deceived her
te ko, "otca e!a hin ku 'm n|ang sa
and said, "we here are eating raisin berries that are
g!aan te ku khau ka sa !a'u
red and are picking those that are white
n|ang a hin ǁ'a tci-tcia a oo khaua, n|ang nǁah ǁ'a a khau |'u n|ang sa g!aan
now you should gather the same way, don't gather and put (in the bag) those that are red
ka si tcoahn ha
that's how they deceived her
te ha re ku gom ǁ'atca te khau ka tzanasi te gom ǁ'atca te khau ka tzanasi te
and did she swallow those and pick the unripe ones, and swallow that and pick the unripe ones and
si !'oansi g!a'in
their carrying skins were full
te si ka ku, si sin tani ka te kharu ǁ'a g!u-n!ang ma te g!hoo
and they, they just brought them and went down to the little waterhole and sat
te si ko "!'hai, a koara tci !'an o a ga n|ang e se"
and they said "hare, take off your carrying skin so we can see"
te si kua si koara ka te ka !xau te o tci tzanasi re
and they quickly, they took it off and were surprised that it (contained) unripe things

te si!a ko
and they said
"a he xae ǁoeh ǁau ku khau te e!a hin ku khau tci dore sin?"
have you in fact collected well and we all here have collected bad things?
te koara te ka
and took it off and it was
g!a'an te ha ko "g!omsi !a'u !a'u !a'u
red and she said, "white, white, white (diseased) crotches
hatce re i!a koe du ǀ'an mi?"
what have you all done to me?"
te si ko "ha-m taqm ka nǀang ǁ'a a te
and they said "dump it out and then you should
n!uan ce, e!a te g!hooa koa tsi ke, te !an a
go back, we will sit here, and wait for you
nǀang a gǀae khau ka nǀang tsi nǀang m u"
now you go pick it and then come so we can go"
te ha taqm ka te
and she dumped it out and
!'hu u ka
went off gathering and
te si ko "otca m!a ku u,
and they said, "we're going to go,
ǀoa ku g!hoo !an ha ko koa ke te ku u,
we're not going to sit and wait for her here but are going to go,
nǀang i!a gǀxam
now you all piss
nǀang !oa gǀxama o i!a ga nǀang ko ka ha du he ku !'au
and tell your piss that when she calls out
ǁ'a gǀxama ku !'au ha"
the piss should call to her"
si!a nǀuia ku zi ku !oa zi ka ko "nǀa a du !'au ha"
(also) one of them shat and told the shit, saying, "now you call out to her"
ka si!a to'a ka u
and then they went off
te ha u
and she went
ǁama ǁ'akoa te u khau, khau,khau ka te ku tsi
came from there and went picking, picked and picked it and came back
te gu g!xa !ama n!a'an to'a te
and took out that big bulb (Ceropegia multiflora tentaculata) and
ku nǀoqn ka tsi
was eating it as she came back

te ku ǂae-ǂae si kokxuisi te ǀoa tsa'a te ku !'au
and was listening for their speech but didn't hear them and called out
ka zi hin tsi !'au ka ha tsi gǀae se tama
the shit there called out and she came there but didn't see (the people)
ka ku !'au ka gǀxam hin tsi !'au ka ha tsi gǀae se tama
so she called out, and the piss there called back so she went there and didn't see them
ku koh te ha n!au n!a'an
while she was doing that, the old man
ho a kore ko ǁo'a te ǁ'a ha te nǀanga ǁ'a tsii si goaq !om ha ǁ'akaa n!anga
had found somewhere a tortoise and then he sat at the entrance to the hole where they had earlier buried him
du cao ka tzi te nǀang te ǁohm ka
widening its entrance and sitting and chopping it
ǁha ,ǁha ,ǁha ,ǁha
(onomatop.)
te ha ko "hajoe xae ce te
and she said "who is this now again,
ju nǀui xae?"
is it a person?"
te kxoa ǁ'a jua
and looked for that person
kxoa ha te ǀxoa ho ha te o ǂaun te ha ko "yaih"
looked for him and didn't see him and was going past but he said "hey"
te ha mani te se
and she turned and saw
te ha ko "hoe"
and he said "come here"
te ha n!un mani te ku oo ǁaea ǁ'a tca te
and she stood and turned around and was holding that (bulb) and
te ha ko "a m sin nǂhaoh
and he said "you just walk
!'hae nǀang tsi na tca to'a a ku 'm
quickly and come give me that thing you're eating
!ama to'a a ǁae"
that (bulb) there you have"
te ha ko "ooh,
and she said "oh,
tca jua he tsi goaq !ai he oo !au, hajoe xae cete?"
that this person long ago died and left, who is this then again?"
nǁah te tsi, tsi n!uan tca
left and came, came and stood there

tjutzi khoe te n!uan koa ǂxan te !'anga ka ko !ai te
about as far as the house door is and stood far away and stuck it with a digging stick and
ku |'an ha ko ha te ha !xau te ko "'in-in
offered it to him but he refused and said "no
mi m |oa ooa a ko tci n|ui n|ang a tsi na
I won't do anything to you, so come and give me
!ama, hatce xae mi ku ooa a?"
the (bulb), what would I do to you?"
te a ku n!un ǂxan
but she stood far from him
okaa ju gesin ǁama koa ke te
and the other people came from here and
ku !au nǂau koa ke
and were moving here
te ha tse ka ku |'an ha !ama te ha
and she gave him the (bulb) and he
gu ha te ǁhai |'ua ha ko dom n!ang
grabbed her and pulled her into the hole
te ko "a xae koaq mi?
and said "are you afraid of me?
a ko mi te goaq nǂau kore te ku koaq mi ,mi m
where are you saying I went that you fear me, I
ge te mi hin tsi he
am alive, and it is I here
te |oa dua a ko tci n|ui, te ku !oa a
and won't do anything to you, but am telling you
tsi !oa a ka a u !oa jusa, ju gesin sa u he
came to tell you so you can go tell people, those other people over there
te ǂaun, te !au nǂau koa ke
who passed by and moved over there
n|ang a
then you
bah ka mi ǁkoa a wa a ku...
but if I send you there can you do it
a ku du ǁ'atca?"
you, could you do that thing?"
te ha ko "inn, n|a"
then she said "yes, certainly"
te ha ko "!aah,
and he said "run,
!aah n|ang u, ua si khoea n|ang !oa si n|ang
run to those people, go near them, then tell them that

jua ku !ai
a person who dies
ha ku ǂoa mi ka ku ǀxoa
will imitate me and be alive
ka ku !ai ka ku ǀxoa, nǁah ǁ'a ha kua !ai, 'in-in
and will die and then be alive, he won't quickly die, no
nǀang ku !ai nǀang ku ǀxoa, nǀang ku !ai nǀang ǀxoa
he will die and then be alive, and will die and then be alive
ǁ'atca ju oo
that's what people will do
oo ǀxoa nǁah ǁ'a ju ku kua !ai"
will be alive, won't quickly die"
te ha ko "inn, nǀa"
and she said "yes, of course"
"a bah ǁau tsa'a mi, u ǁau !oa si?" "ee mi ǁau tsa'a"
"do you understand me well, will you go tell them well?" "Yes, I understand well"
ka ha !aah, !aah,!aah, !aah
and she ran, ran, ran, ran
tsi gǀae si ku koe tju sa ke g!hoo he o ha gea khoe sa ke te
came and they were as close as these houses standing here, she was there and
!'au si te si gǁa
called them and they stood
te ha taa ko "n!ui n!a'an o ha ku ko i
and she said "the old moon said you
ka i ku !ao i oo i
when you die you will, you
kua !ao u nǀang nǁah ǀxoa
will quickly die and be gone and not be alive
Juǀ'hoan !uisi te ǁku ǀkau"
dead people's flesh will smell bad "
"!'hai m he tzin, nǀa..."
"it is the hare coming along here, of course..."
te si ko "ooh,
and they said "oh,
a he bah xae ǁama kore te a kokxuisi koe ta'm?"
where has this one come from with speech that sounds like this?"
te ha ko "tca n!ui n!a'an koh !oa mi, kohm, mi ku !oa i!a"
and she said "what the old moon told me, for sure, is what I'm telling you"
te ko "i kua !ao nǁah ǁ'a i ku ǀxoa"
and said "you're going to die, now don't be alive"
n!uan ce
went back

te si ko "a n|a ni to'a a te ko
and they said "you obviously should go away since you said
tsi n‡oahn e ko ka, n|ang a ni to'a"
came and told us that, now you go away"
te ha g|aea ha
and she went back to him
te ku are ka ha n!uan tzi he !oa ha ko ka ha g|ae u, te ha ko "tsi,
and wanted to stay outside and tell him that she had gone, but he said, "come,
tci n|ui a !oa mi"
you'll tell me something"
sa g!a'ama te tsi g|ae
they two went in and arrived
"a bah u koh hatce !oa kxui si?"
"what did you go and tell them?"
"mi n|a koh ko si
"I certainly said they
!ao u n|ang ǁ'a si te oo,
would die and go away , that's how it would be,
ju|'hoan !uisi te ǁku |kau"
that dead people's flesh will smell bad"
te ha kua tsi
and he quickly
gu |'ai te ka ǁohm !hara ha tzi, ka to'a, !'hai tzi ka khoe
took an axe and chopped-split her mouth, that is why the hare's mouth is like that
te g!o'e !'an ha ko !oq'u he o ha ku tsi
and the gemsbok skin she had wrapped around her she quickly
g!xa, ha he o !'hai te
took it off, this one who was the hare and
gǁxuan da'a te tse
lay it on the fire and
nǁoba kxai ha
threw it over
!'hoan |ho, ka tsi ka to'a ka
the man's face, and that's why the
n!ui |ho koh
moon's face
o |kurisi
is dirty
tsi o ha g!o'e te ka ha ku
it was the gemsbok skin and when she
ǁua ha |ho ko ka he oo ku !aah g|a'i , ha !'hoan ku
put it on his face and ran away, the man

koh ka g!o'e di ka ǀkurisi ce to'a te koh xa gea ha ǀho
since that time the dirt of the female gemsbok skin has been on his face
ǁ'atca sa ǀ'u te dua ǁ'akoa
that is what they stayed and did there
te ǁ'a !aia tsi ke te e ka kua ku !ao u te ǀoa ǀxoa
and that's the death here that we quickly die and are not alive
ka n!uan koa to'a
it ends here